



## ***Technology Use Policy – Camp Conway & Camp Sierpinski***

At Camp Conway and Camp Sierpinski, part of the National Math Camps network, we are deeply committed to cultivating a vibrant, focused, and connected community. One of the ways we support this goal is by minimizing the presence of personal technology during camp. While we recognize the value of digital tools in everyday life, we intentionally create a screen-light environment that fosters friendship, immersion in math, and joyful participation in all aspects of camp life.

### ***Cell Phone Policy***

We ask that every camper bring a mobile phone and charger for use during travel to and from camp, as well as for scheduled family check-ins while at camp. However, to protect the spirit of camp and promote meaningful in-person engagement, cell phones will not be in campers' possession during the day. Phones will be collected by counselors at check-in, stored securely, and returned to campers during designated daily phone times for calling home. This time will be consistent and predictable, giving families peace of mind and allowing campers a daily opportunity to connect with home without distracting from their camp experience.

We request that all phones be labeled with indelible identification on the outside (e.g., using a permanent marker or heavy-duty label) and have the camper's name displayed on both the lock screen and background image.

### ***Electronics Policy***

Our electronics policy is designed to support a safe, focused, and enriching camp environment. It aligns with best practices recommended by the American Camp Association and reflects our belief that temporary separation from digital devices supports personal growth, deeper connection, and the intellectual focus that defines Camp Conway and Camp Sierpinski.

Devices not permitted for use during camp include:

- Cell phones (outside of scheduled call-home time)
- Laptop computers
- Digital tablets (including iPads and similar devices) (Note: some families choose to send campers with an iPad or tablet for calls home; in this case, it will be made available to your camper during the scheduled call-home time)
- Smartwatches
- Handheld gaming consoles

Upon arrival, campers will turn in all devices listed above to their assigned Counselor, who will safely store them for the duration of camp, except during scheduled call-home periods. Daily



device access (for calls home only) will occur in the morning and evening (times to be specified prior to camp). Campers must comply with this policy fully; failure to do so may result in disciplinary action, including confiscation of the device and/or early dismissal from camp. In the case of a family or medical emergency, please contact the Camp Director directly. Emergency contact numbers for Conway and Sierpinski will be provided prior to camp. Staff will be available at the on-call number 24/7 during the camp session.

### ***Permitted Devices***

Campers are welcome to bring screen-free or offline devices, such as:

- Standalone MP3 players (that do not have Wi-Fi or Bluetooth connectivity)
- E-readers such as Kindles or Kobos without internet access

These devices may be used during free time or evening wind-down hours, as approved by camp staff.

We are confident that this approach enhances the unique and immersive experience that Camp Conway and Camp Sierpinski offer. If you have any questions about this policy, please contact us at [info@nationalmathcamps.org](mailto:info@nationalmathcamps.org) or 888-579-MATH (6284).

Thank you for supporting our mission to create a joyful, focused, and connected summer of learning and growth.